GEORGIA-CAROLINA COUNCIL · RANGE AND TARGET ACTIVITIES

RATA Instructor Guide

How RATA emails, your RATA page and event sign-ups work

This guide is for every RATA instructor, range safety officer and volunteer. You never need a password or an account. Everything works from the emails we send and the links inside them.

FIRST All RATA email now comes from **Georgia-Carolina RATA**. Add that sender (and gacashootingsports@gmail.com) to your contacts so nothing lands in spam. If you find a RATA email in spam, mark it "Not spam" once.

1. The emails you get

Email	When	What to do
Weekly RATA email	Monday morning, only when something needs you	Answer events with Yes / Maybe / No. Open your RATA page for everything else.
Change notice	Right away, only when an event date changes or it is cancelled (or the time or place changes in the last 3 days)	Read it. If you can no longer make it, tap No.
Reminder / day-before	Before an event you said Yes to	Report time, place, what to bring. Event leads also get the upcoming events handout.
Credential reminders	Before your NRA, archery or Safeguarding Youth Training (SYT) certificate expires	Renew, then send the new date on your RATA page.
Still interested?	Once a month, only if your record is marked inactive	Tap **Yes, update my details** to come back, or **No longer interested** to stop these emails.

Subjects end with a short tag like **[RATA-AB12]**. Please leave it there when you reply. It lets the system match your reply to the right event.

2. Answering an event

Each event in the weekly email has three buttons:

- **Yes** – you will be there. You get reminders and the day-before details.
- **Maybe** – we will check back with you closer to the date.
- **No** – no more emails about that event.

Emails about a single event (with a [RATA-...] tag in the subject) can also be answered by replying YES, MAYBE or NO. Changed your mind? Tap a different button any time before the event.

Every weekly email ends with a short **How RATA emails work** note and a link to this guide.

RULE **One event a day.** You can be asked about more than one event on the same day, but you can say Yes to only one of them. If you are already signed up that day, the page tells you which event and asks you to answer No or Maybe (or, for a multi-day event, mark that day **Not this day**).

3. Your RATA page

Every email has an **Open my RATA page** button. It is your own private page. Do not forward the email, because the link opens your page without a password.

Section	What it shows
Needs your answer	Events you were asked about. Tap **Answer** for Yes / Maybe / No.
You are signed up for	Events you said Yes to, with your role.
Upcoming events	One dated list of everything else for the next six months. A green **Help needed** label means a spot you are qualified for is open: tap **I can help**. A blue **Instructional opportunity** label is an NRA course you can take: tap **I want to take this course**. A course can show both.
Documents	Forms, checklists and range documents for the team.
My details	Phone, address, certificates, shirt size, diet and emergency contact. Tap **Update my details** to change them. A director reviews changes before they are saved.
Director list (directors only)	Items waiting for a director. See the Director Guide.

Leave the page open if you like: it checks for changes every minute and updates itself.

Keep your details complete

If something is missing, such as your phone, address, certificate number, SYT date or **emergency contact**, the weekly email will have a short **Please complete your details** section. It shows at most once every 4 weeks, and it stops as soon as your details are complete.

> **TIP** Emergency contact is new. Please add the name, relationship and phone of someone we can call if you are hurt at a range. Event leads see it on the event roster.

4. NRA courses

- NRA courses you could take show in **Upcoming events** with a blue **Instructional opportunity** label.
- If you can already teach part of a course (for example you are a rifle instructor and the course is Rifle and Shotgun), you are asked to help teach it and can also take it for the part you lack. Choosing **I want to take this course** turns the teaching request into a student seat.
- NRA courses welcome any number of assistant instructors, so they stay under **Help needed** even after the minimum is met.
- A director reviews student requests and confirms your seat. **No thanks** removes a course you were offered.
- NRA courses must be led by someone who holds the right rating. For example, a Basic Rifle course needs an NRA Rifle Instructor. BIT and Instructor courses need an NRA Training Counselor, and an RSO course needs an NRA Chief RSO.

5. If you are the event lead

- The day before, you get the full roster (phones, shirt sizes, diet notes and emergency contacts) and a check-in link.
- Your day-before email has an attached PDF, **Upcoming RATA events**. It lists the next six months of events, has a QR code that troops can scan to request their own event, and links to the council RATA page. Print it or show it at the range.

- After the event, use the link in your email to mark who came.

6. Help

Questions? Reply to any RATA email or write to gacashootingsports@gmail.com. Lost your link? Open the newest RATA email. Every email carries a fresh link to your page.